A Report on "A Study on Consumer Preferences for Local Retailers Over Supershops in Bangladesh"

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Submitted by: Asif Uddin Mazumder.

ID: 2103055. Reg: 10262. Group: B

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Faculty of Business Administration

Patuakhali Science and Technology University (PSTU)

Submitted to:

Dr. Imranul Islam Professor Department of Marketing Faculty of Business Administration Patuakhali Science and Technology University	**Dr. Afjal Hossain** Professor Department of Marketing Faculty of Business Administration Patuakhali Science and Technology University

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Group Member Details

ID	Reg.	Name	Signature
2103027	10234	Rayma Zaman Upoma	
2103055	10262	Asif Uddin Mazumder	
2103058	10265	Israt Jahan Nafisa	
2103088	10295	Hritu Tanchangya	
2103095	10302	Samia Akter	
2103097	10304	Tasnim Wazid Dola	
2103099	10306	Mohammad Bin Salam	

Evaluation Details

ID. No	Reg. No.	Name	Signature	Writing(10)	Presentation(5)	Q&A(5)	Total(20)
2103027	10234	Rayma Zaman Upoma					
2103055	10262	Asif Uddin Mazumder					
2103058	10265	Israt Jahan Nafisa					
2103088	10295	Hritu Tanchangya					
2103095	10302	Samia Akter					
2103097	10304	Tasnim Wazid Dola					
2103099	10306	Mohammad Bin Salam					

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Finally, we would like to express that this report has been prepared based on our experiences and information from primary data but there could have been some unwilling errors and lacking, we hope that you would be kind enough to accept those.

Regards

_____

Asif Uddin Mazumder

Level 3, Semester-II

Faculty of Business Administration

Patuakhali Science and Technology University

Faculty of Business Administration
Patuakhali Science and Technology University

Date: 03/12/2025

Professor Dr. Imranul Islam

Department of Marketing

Faculty of Business Administration

&

Professor Dr. Afjal Hossain

Department of Marketing

Faculty of Business Administration

Subject: **Letter of Transmittal**

Dear sir,

This is our immense pleasure for having the opportunity that you have assigned us to submit the report "**A Study on Consumer Preferences for Local Retailers Over Supershops in Bangladesh**" as a partial requirement of the course "Business Research Methodology" (Course code: 32041404). This report has been prepared based on primary data.

Therefore, we would like to place this report on your kind judgment and valuable suggestions.

Yours sincerely

Asif Uddin Mazumder

Level 3, Semester-II

Faculty of Business Administration

Patuakhali Science and Technology University

Executive Summary

This research investigates the persistent consumer preference for traditional local retailers, such as *Mudir Dokan* and *Kacha Bazar*, over modern supershops in the semi-urban area of Dumki Upazila, Barishal. Despite the rapid expansion of modern retail chains across Bangladesh, a vast majority of consumers continue to rely on unorganized local markets for their daily necessities. To understand the underlying psychological drivers of this behavior, this study applied the Theory of Planned Behavior (TPB) as the theoretical framework. The research utilized a quantitative approach, collecting data from 350 respondents through a structured online questionnaire to measure how Attitude, Subjective Norms, and Perceived Behavioral Control influence the intention to shop locally.

The data analysis, conducted using IBM SPSS Statistics, revealed that the TPB model is a robust predictor of consumer behavior in this context, explaining 43.4% of the variance in purchase intention. The regression results identified Attitude as the most significant predictor, indicating that consumers favor local retailers primarily because of positive perceptions regarding product freshness, bargaining opportunities, and personal relationships with shopkeepers. Perceived Behavioral Control was the second strongest factor, confirming that the close proximity of local stores and the ease of cash transactions provide a logistical advantage that supershops currently struggle to match. Subjective Norms also played a significant, though smaller, role, showing that family and social habits still encourage traditional shopping.

In conclusion, this study demonstrates that the preference for local retailers is not just a habit, but a calculated choice driven by the superior convenience and perceived value of fresh products offered by traditional markets. The findings suggest that local retailers remain highly competitive against modern supershops in semi-urban Bangladesh. For supershop managers and investors, the study implies that attracting this customer base will require more than just air-conditioned stores; it will require strategies that address the core consumer demands for freshness, competitive pricing, and accessibility that are currently being met by the local *Mudir Dokan*.

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Chapter 1: Introduction

1.1 Background of the Study

The retail sector in Bangladesh is currently undergoing a significant transitional phase, characterized by the dual existence of traditional unorganized retailing and modern organized retailing. For decades, the Bangladeshi consumer landscape has been dominated by traditional formats, primarily "Mudir Dokan" (neighborhood grocery stores) and "Kacha Bazar" (wet markets). These local retailers have served as the backbone of the economy, offering proximity, personalized services, and fresh produce to millions of households.

However, the last two decades have witnessed the rapid emergence of modern retail formats. Supermarket chains such as *Shwapno*, *Agora*, and *Meena Bazar* have expanded their footprint, offering consumers a one-stop shopping experience in a hygienic, air-conditioned environment. Despite this modernization drive and the growing middle-class population, traditional local retailers continue to command a massive share of the retail market. This unique coexistence suggests that the transition to modern retailing in Bangladesh is not linear, and consumer preferences are driven by complex factors beyond just convenience or price.

1.2 Problem Statement

Despite the aggressive expansion and marketing efforts of modern supershops, a large segment of Bangladeshi consumers still prefers to conduct their daily grocery shopping at local retailers. While supershops offer comfort and variety, many consumers remain loyal to their local *Mudir Dokan* and wet markets. This resistance to switching raises critical questions for marketers and investors. Are consumers driven by the perceived freshness of products in wet markets? Is it the social connection with the shopkeeper? Or are there logistical barriers preventing them from accessing supershops?

There is a lack of sufficient research that applies psychological frameworks to understand these specific drivers in the context of semi-urban areas like Dumki, Barishal. Without understanding the psychological "why"-specifically the roles of attitude, social pressure, and behavioral control-modern retailers cannot formulate effective strategies to attract customers, and local retailers may struggle to adapt to changing times. This study addresses this gap by applying the Theory of

Planned Behavior (TPB) to interpret the underlying motivations behind consumer preferences for local retailers over supershops.

1.3 Research Objectives

The primary aim of this study is to understand consumer decision-making regarding retail format choice in Bangladesh using a structured theoretical framework.

The specific objectives are:

1. To apply the Theory of Planned Behavior (TPB) to predict consumer intention to shop at local retailers.
2. To analyze the impact of **Attitude** (e.g., freshness, price, bargaining) on the intention to choose local retailers.
3. To examine the influence of **Subjective Norms** (social and family pressure) on the consumer's decision to shop locally.
4. To evaluate the role of **Perceived Behavioral Control** (e.g., proximity, payment ease) in shaping the intention to choose local retailers over supershops.

1.4 Significance of the Study

The findings of this study will offer valuable insights to various stakeholders in the Bangladesh retail ecosystem:

- **Retail Managers & Marketers:** Managers of supershops can use these insights to understand the specific psychological barriers preventing consumers from visiting their stores (e.g., if "Attitude towards freshness" is low for supershops, they can focus marketing on quality).
- **Local Retailers (SMEs):** Small business owners can understand their key strengths (such as relationships and accessibility) and leverage them to retain their customer base against corporate competition.
- **Policymakers:** Understanding consumer behavior helps in urban planning and developing policies that support the coexistence of SMEs and large retail chains.
- **Investors:** For investors looking at the Bangladeshi retail sector, this study provides a realistic view of consumer loyalty to traditional formats, helping in better feasibility analysis for new outlets.

Chapter 2: Literature Review and Conceptual Framework

2.1 The Evolving Retail Landscape in Developing Economies

The retail sector in developing countries like Bangladesh is undergoing a significant transformation, characterized by the co-existence of traditional and modern retail formats. Historically, consumers have relied on unorganized local retailers, such as neighborhood grocery stores (*mudir dokan*) and wet markets (*kacha bazar*), for their daily necessities (Hassan M. K., 2018).These traditional formats are deeply embedded in the social fabric, offering benefits such as proximity, personalized service, the availability of fresh produce, and the opportunity for bargaining (Sultana, 2020).

Conversely, the last two decades have seen the emergence and gradual growth of organized retailing, including supermarkets and supershops. These modern formats differentiate themselves by offering a wide assortment of products under one roof, a hygienic and air-conditioned shopping environment, fixed pricing, and quality assurance (Chowdhury, 2019). Despite the modern appeal of supershops, local retailers continue to dominate a significant portion of the market share in Bangladesh. This persistent preference for traditional formats raises important questions about the psychological and behavioral drivers governing consumer store choice in a transitional economy. Understanding these dynamics is crucial for retailers to formulate effective strategies.

2.2 Theoretical Framework: The Theory of Planned Behavior (TPB)

To understand the complex decision-making process involved in choosing a retail format, this study adopts the Theory of Planned Behavior (TPB) proposed by (Ajzen, 1991). The TPB is a widely accepted psychological framework designed to predict and explain human social behavior in specific contexts. The central tenet of the theory is that an individual's intention to perform a given behavior is the most immediate predictor of their actual behavior.

According to (Ajzen, 1991), behavioral intention is determined by three independent constructs:

1. **Attitude towards the Behavior:** The degree to which a person has a favorable or unfavorable evaluation of the behavior in question.
2. **Subjective Norms:** The perceived social pressure to perform or not perform the behavior, stemming from the influence of important referent groups like family and peers.

3. **Perceived Behavioral Control (PBC):** An individual's perception of the ease or difficulty of performing the behavior, reflecting past experiences and anticipated obstacles.

The TPB has been successfully applied in numerous studies to explain diverse consumer behaviors, including food choices, online shopping adoption, and retail format selection in various cultural contexts (Han, 2010) (Uddin, 2010). Its ability to capture both personal motivations and social influences makes it highly suitable for examining the comparative preference for local retailers versus supershops.

2.3 Application of TPB in Retail Store Choice

Attitude towards Local Retailers Consumer attitude plays a pivotal role in store choice. Research indicates that attitudes towards local retailers are often shaped by perceptions of product freshness, particularly for perishables like meat and vegetables, which are frequently believed to be superior in traditional markets compared to the packaged offerings in supershops (Rahman, 2021). Furthermore, the functional benefit of price negotiation and the emotional value of personal interaction with local shopkeepers contribute to a positive attitude toward traditional formats (Sultana, 2020).While supershops are valued for convenience and ambiance, the perceived core value proposition of local markets often leads to a stronger favorable evaluation for daily purchases among many Bangladeshi consumers.

Subjective Norms and Social Influence In collectivistic societies like Bangladesh, social influence is a critical determinant of behavior. Subjective norms capture the perceived expectations of family members, friends, and societal peers regarding where one "should" shop. Studies have shown that older generations often prefer and advocate for traditional markets due to long-standing habits and trust, thereby creating social pressure on younger family members to do the same (Chowdhury, Consumer preference for superstores in Dhaka city: An empirical study, 2019).Conversely, there can also be peer pressure among urban youth to shop at modern supershops as a sign of sophistication or modernity. The final intention is often a balance of these conflicting social forces.

Perceived Behavioral Control (PBC) Perceived behavioral control relates to the practical constraints and facilitators of shopping. Key factors influencing PBC in the retail context include the physical proximity of the store, the availability of transport, and financial resources. Local retailers are often located within walking distance of residential areas, providing high accessibility and ease for frequent, small-ticket purchases (Hassan M. K., 2018). In contrast, supershops are

typically situated in commercial hubs, requiring travel and time commitment. Additionally, the fixed-price model and perceived higher cost of supershops can be a barrier for cost-conscious consumers, whereas the flexibility of cash transactions and credit availability at local stores enhances the sense of control for many shoppers (Uddin, 2010).

2.4 Conceptual Framework and Research Gap

While existing literature has extensively explored consumer behavior in retail, fewer studies have specifically applied the TPB model to directly compare the preference for traditional versus modern retail formats within the specific socio-economic context of Bangladesh. This study aims to bridge this gap by empirically testing how attitude, subjective norms, and perceived behavioral control collectively influence the intention to choose local retailers over supershops.

Based on the theoretical underpinnings of the TPB and the literature reviewed, the following conceptual framework is proposed for this study:

Figure 2.1: Conceptual Framework based on TPB

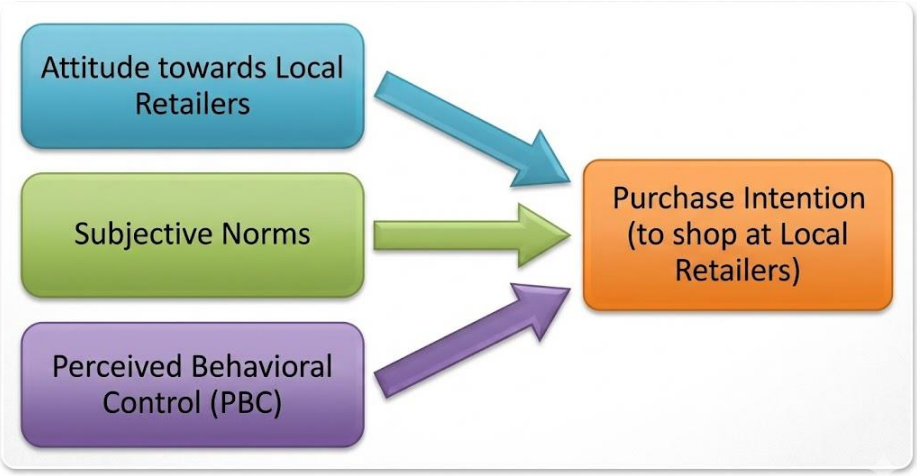

Figure 2.1: Conceptual Framework based on TPB

The study suggests the following hypotheses based on this framework:

- **H1:** A favorable attitude towards local retailers has a positive influence on the intention to shop there.
- **H2:** Subjective norms positively influence the intention to choose local retailers.
- **H3:** Perceived behavioral control has a positive impact on the intention to shop at local retailers.

Chapter 3: Research Methodology

3.1 Research Design

This study employs a quantitative research design that is both descriptive and causal in nature. The descriptive phase of the research is used to profile the demographic characteristics of the respondents and to describe their current attitudes and shopping habits regarding local retailers versus supershops. The causal phase is designed to test the theoretical framework based on the Theory of Planned Behavior (TPB). Specifically, it seeks to establish cause-and-effect relationships by measuring how independent variables (Attitude, Subjective Norms, and Perceived Behavioral Control) influence the dependent variable (Purchase Intention).

3.2 Sampling Design

Target Population The target population for this study consists of general consumers residing in Dumki Upazila, Barishal. This area was selected to represent a semi-urban consumer base where both traditional local markets (Mudir Dokan/Kacha Bazar) and emerging modern retail formats are accessible to residents.

Sample Size To ensure statistical validity for the regression analysis, a sample size of 350 respondents was determined. This sample size exceeds the minimum requirements for quantitative studies using multivariate analysis, ensuring that the results are robust and representative of the target population.

Sampling Technique The study utilized a Convenience Sampling technique. Due to time and resource constraints, respondents were selected based on their availability and willingness to participate. This method allowed for efficient data collection from a diverse group of residents, students, and professionals living within the Dumki Upazila area.

3.3 Data Collection Instrument

Primary data was collected using a **structured questionnaire** distributed online via **Google Forms**. The questionnaire was divided into two sections:

1. **Demographic Information:** Questions regarding age, gender, and monthly income to profile the respondents.

2. **TPB Constructs:** Specific questions measuring Attitude, Subjective Norms, Perceived Behavioral Control, and Purchase Intention.

Measurement Scale All variables related to the Theory of Planned Behavior were measured using a **5-point Likert Scale**, where respondents indicated their level of agreement with various statements. The scale ranged from **1 = Strongly Disagree** to **5 = Strongly Agree**, with 3 representing a Neutral stance. This standardized scale allowed for the precise quantification of consumer psychological traits.

3.4 Data Analysis Tools

The collected data was first cleaned and coded in Microsoft Excel before being imported into **IBM SPSS Statistics (Version 27)** for analysis. The following statistical tools were employed:

- **Descriptive Statistics:** To analyze frequencies, means, and standard deviations of the demographic and study variables.
- **Reliability Analysis:** Cronbach's Alpha was calculated to ensure the internal consistency of the questionnaire items.
- **Multiple Regression Analysis:** To test the research hypotheses and determine the strength of the relationship between the independent and dependent variables.

Chapter 4: Data Analysis & Findings

"Table 1: Demographic Profile."

Statistics				
		Age	Gender	Income
N	Valid	350	350	350
	Missing	0	0	0
Mean		2.44	1.53	2.52

Age					
		Frequency	Percent	Valid Percent	Cumulative Percent
Valid	18-24	98	28.0	28.0	28.0
	25-34	91	26.0	26.0	54.0
	35-44	71	20.3	20.3	74.3
	45+	90	25.7	25.7	100.0
	Total	350	100.0	100.0	

The study surveyed a total of 350 respondents with no missing data. The age distribution among participants is quite diverse. The largest segment of respondents belongs to the **18-24 years** age group, representing **28.0% (n=98)** of the total sample. This is followed closely by the **25-34 years** group at **26.0% (n=91)** and the **45+ years** group at **25.7% (n=90)**. The smallest group is aged between **35-44 years**, comprising **20.3% (n=71)** of the respondents. This indicates that the survey captured insights from across a broad age spectrum.

Gender					
		Frequency	Percent	Valid Percent	Cumulative Percent
Valid	Male	165	47.1	47.1	47.1
	Female	185	52.9	52.9	100.0
	Total	350	100.0	100.0	

Regarding the gender composition of the 350 participants, the sample is relatively well-balanced. **Female** respondents constitute the slight majority, accounting for **52.9% (n=185)** of the total. **Male** respondents make up the remaining **47.1% (n=165)**. This balanced distribution ensures that the perspectives of both genders are adequately represented in the study's findings.

Income					
		Frequency	Percent	Valid Percent	Cumulative Percent
Valid	Below 20K	95	27.1	27.1	27.1
	20k-40K	75	21.4	21.4	48.6
	40K-60K	82	23.4	23.4	72.0
	Above 60K	98	28.0	28.0	100.0
	Total	350	100.0	100.0	

The income profile of the respondents shows a wide variance in economic status. Interestingly, the highest representation comes from the two extremes of the income brackets used in the survey. The largest group earns **Above 60K BDT** monthly, comprising **28.0% (n=98)** of the sample, followed closely by those earning **Below 20K BDT** at **27.1% (n=95)**. The middle-income groups, **40K-60K** and **20k-40K**, represent **23.4% (n=82)** and **21.4% (n=75)** of respondents, respectively. This diversity allows for analysis across different economic segments of the population.

4.1 Reliability Test

Scale: Attitude

Reliability Statistics	
Cronbach's Alpha	N of Items
.910	5

The reliability analysis for the Attitude construct, which comprises five items measuring consumers' favorable or unfavorable evaluation of local retailers, yielded a Cronbach's Alpha coefficient of .910. This value far exceeds the recommended threshold of 0.70, indicating excellent

internal consistency reliability. This suggests that the survey questions used to measure Attitude are highly consistent and reliable.

Scale: Subjective Norms

Reliability Statistics	
Cronbach's Alpha	N of Items
.891	4

The **Subjective Norms** scale, consisting of four items designed to measure social pressure and influence regarding retail choice, demonstrated strong reliability with a Cronbach's Alpha of **.891**. This result indicates very good internal consistency among the items, confirming that the scale reliably measures the intended construct.

Scale: PBC

Reliability Statistics	
Cronbach's Alpha	**N of Items**
.879	**4**

For the Perceived Behavioral Control (PBC) scale, based on four items assessing the ease or difficulty of shopping locally, the Cronbach's Alpha was calculated at .879. This result falls well above the acceptable range, indicating good internal consistency and reliability for this measurement scale.

Scale: Intention

Reliability Statistics	
Cronbach's Alpha	**N of Items**
.834	**3**

Finally, the Purchase Intention scale, which serves as the dependent variable and was measured using three items, showed a Cronbach's Alpha of .834. This indicates good internal consistency reliability, confirming that the items used are a reliable measure of the respondents' intention to shop at local retailers.

4.2 Descriptive Statistics for Variables

Descriptive Statistics					
	N	Minimum	Maximum	Mean	Std. Deviation
ATT_1	350	1	5	3.48	.923
ATT_2	350	1	5	3.48	.914
ATT_3	350	1	5	3.50	.923
ATT_4	350	1	5	3.47	.907
ATT_5	350	1	5	3.49	.926
SN_1	350	1	5	3.47	.849
SN_2	350	1	5	3.50	.898
SN_3	350	1	5	3.48	.914
SN_4	350	1	5	3.46	.922
PBC_1	350	1	5	3.50	.926
PBC_2	350	1	5	3.48	.904
PBC_3	350	1	5	3.44	.903
PBC_4	350	1	5	3.48	.882
INT_1	350	1	5	3.47	.920
INT_2	350	1	5	3.50	.908
INT_3	350	1	5	3.49	.908
BEH_1	350	1	4	2.59	1.096
BEH_2	350	1	4	2.42	1.117
Valid N (listwise)	350				

The descriptive statistics for the measurement items reveal that respondents generally hold a slightly positive to neutral perception towards local retailers across all constructs. For **Attitude**,

the mean scores range from **3.47 to 3.50** on a 5-point scale, indicating a moderately favorable evaluation of local shops. **Subjective Norms** show a similar trend, with mean scores between **3.46 and 3.50**, suggesting moderate social pressure or influence to shop locally. The items for **Perceived Behavioral Control (PBC)** also fall within a similar range (**M = 3.44 to 3.50**), implying that respondents feel they have a moderate level of control over their decision to shop at local retailers. Consistently, the **Intention** to shop locally is moderately positive, with mean scores ranging from **3.47 to 3.50**. The standard deviations for all these Likert-scale items are around **0.9**, indicating a reasonable amount of variation in the responses.

In contrast, the **Actual Behavior (BEH)** items, which were measured on a different 4-point scale, show lower mean scores (**M = 2.59 and 2.42**). This suggests that while the intention and attitude towards local retailers are moderately positive, the reported frequency of actual shopping behavior is comparatively lower.

4.3 Multiple Regression Analysis

Table 1: Model Summary

Model Summary				
Model	**R**	**R Square**	**Adjusted R Square**	**Std. Error of the Estimate**
1	**.659[a]**	**.434**	**.429**	**.59675**
a. Predictors: (Constant), Mean_PBC, Mean_ATT, Mean_SN				

The Model Summary table provides an overview of the regression model's ability to explain the variation in the dependent variable, Purchase Intention (Mean_INT). The R Square (R^2) value is .434. This indicates that the three independent variables of the Theory of Planned Behavior model—Attitude (Mean_ATT), Subjective Norms (Mean_SN), and Perceived Behavioral Control (Mean_PBC)—combined explain 43.4% of the total variance in consumers' intention to shop at local retailers. The Adjusted R Square is slightly lower at .429, which confirms that the result is robust and not overly biased by the number of predictors. This suggests that the proposed theoretical model is a moderately strong predictor of consumer intention in this context.

Table 2: Coefficients

Coefficients[a]						
Model		Unstandardized Coefficients		Standardized Coefficients	t	Sig.
		B	Std. Error	Beta		
1	(Constant)	.022	.229		.097	.923
	Mean_ATT	.520	.041	.519	12.728	.000
	Mean_SN	.214	.041	.211	5.162	.000
	Mean_PBC	.261	.042	.256	6.297	.000
a. Dependent Variable: Mean_INT						

The Coefficients table presents the results of the hypothesis testing for each individual predictor. A relationship is considered statistically significant if the **Sig. (p-value)** is less than **0.05**.

- **H1: Attitude → Intention:** The analysis shows a highly significant positive relationship between **Attitude** and Intention ($\beta = .520$, $t = 12.728$, $p < .001$). This means that a more favorable attitude towards local retailers significantly increases the intention to shop there. Therefore, **H1 is supported**.
- **H2: Subjective Norms → Intention:** The result indicates a significant positive impact of **Subjective Norms** on Intention ($\beta = .214$, $t = 5.162$, $p < .001$). This suggests that social pressure and the influence of important others significantly motivate consumers to choose local retailers. Thus, **H2 is supported**.
- **H3: Perceived Behavioral Control → Intention:** The findings reveal that **Perceived Behavioral Control** has a significant positive effect on Intention ($\beta = .261$, $t = 6.297$, $p < .001$). This implies that when consumers feel they have the ability and resources (e.g., time, proximity) to shop locally, their intention to do so increases. Consequently, **H3 is supported**.

Overall, all three constructs of the Theory of Planned Behavior were found to be significant predictors, with **Attitude** having the strongest influence on the intention to choose local retailers over supershops.

Chapter 5: Discussion & Implication

The primary objective of this study was to apply the Theory of Planned Behavior (TPB) to understand the factors influencing consumer preferences for local retailers over supershops in Bangladesh. The findings confirm that the TPB framework is a valid and effective model for predicting consumer intention in this context. The regression analysis revealed that the three core constructs—Attitude, Subjective Norms, and Perceived Behavioral Control—together explain **43.4%** (R square = .434) of the variance in consumers' intention to shop at local retailers.

Hypothesis testing confirmed that all three proposed relationships are statistically significant. **Attitude** emerged as the strongest predictor (β=.520). This indicates that a consumer's personal positive evaluation of local retailers—likely driven by perceptions of freshness, the ability to bargain, and personal relationships with shopkeepers—is the primary driver of their intention to shop there.

Perceived Behavioral Control (PBC) was the second strongest influence (β=.261). This suggests that practical factors, such as the close proximity of local mudir dokan/kacha bazar and the ease of cash transactions, significantly boost the intention to choose them over potentially more distant supershops.

Subjective Norms also showed a significant positive impact (β=.214). This highlights the role of social influence in the Bangladeshi context, where family preferences and community habits still discourage some consumers from shifting entirely to modern supershops.

Interestingly, the descriptive statistics revealed a gap between intention and action. While respondents reported moderately high intentions and attitudes toward local retailers (means around 3.5 on a 5-point scale), their reported actual shopping frequency was notably lower (means around 2.5 on a 4-point scale). This suggests that while consumers psychologically prefer local options, other unmeasured barriers might be preventing them from shopping there as often as they intend.

5.1 Managerial Implications

The findings of this study offer actionable insights for stakeholders in the Bangladeshi retail sector, particularly aimed at how local retailers can maintain their market share against the rise of supershops.

For Local Retailers (Mudir Dokan/Kacha Bazar): Since **Attitude** is the dominant factor, local retailers must double down on their core strengths. They should prioritize maintaining the perceived freshness of perishables (vegetables, meat, fish) and fostering personal relationships with customers, as these are key differentiators that supershops struggle to replicate.

Furthermore, given the significance of **Perceived Behavioral Control**, local retailers must remain convenient. While their location is usually an advantage, they should adapt to modern needs by accepting mobile financial services (like bKash or Nagad) to match the payment ease offered by supershops, thereby removing a potential barrier for younger, tech-savvy consumers.

For Supershops: The strong preference for local retailers driven by attitude indicates that supershops have a perception challenge regarding freshness and pricing. Marketing campaigns aimed at the average Bangladeshi consumer need to aggressively tackle the perception that supershop produce is less fresh or significantly more expensive than the local market.

5.2 Limitations of the Study

While this study provides valuable insights, it is subject to several limitations that should be considered when interpreting the results.

First, the study employed a cross-sectional design, meaning data was collected at a single point in time. Consequently, while associations between variables can be established, definitive causal relationships over time cannot be confirmed.

Second, the study relied on convenience sampling concentrated in major areas. Therefore, the findings may not be fully generalizable to the entire population of Bangladesh, particularly rural consumers whose shopping behaviors and access to supershops differ significantly from urban dwellers.

Finally, the measurement of "Actual Behavior" relied on self-reported data regarding past shopping frequency, which can sometimes be biased compared to observing actual purchase data.

Chapter 6: Conclusion

The retail landscape of Bangladesh is evolving, but as this study confirms, the traditional connection between consumers and local retailers remains exceptionally strong. This research set out to understand the psychological drivers behind the preference for local retailers (such as *Mudir Dokan* and *Kacha Bazar*) over modern supershops in Dumki, Barishal, by applying the Theory of Planned Behavior (TPB).

The study successfully validated the TPB model, demonstrating that Attitude, Subjective Norms, and Perceived Behavioral Control collectively explain 43.4% of the variance in consumer intention. This significant result confirms that the decision to shop locally is not just a habit, but a calculated psychological choice driven by specific factors.

Key Takeaways:

- **Attitude is the Primary Driver:** The strongest predictor of choosing local retailers was **Attitude**. Consumers in Barishal hold a deeply favorable perception of local markets, associating them with fresher produce, the excitement of bargaining, and better pricing. This positive mental evaluation is the biggest barrier for supershops to overcome.
- **Convenience Matters (PBC):** Perceived Behavioral Control was the second most important factor. The proximity of local stores and the ease of cash transactions give them a logistical advantage. For many residents, the local store is simply "easier" to access than a supershop.
- **Social Influence Exists:** While family and peer pressure (Subjective Norms) do influence the decision, they play a supporting role compared to personal attitude and convenience.

The findings suggest that local retailers are not at immediate risk of being replaced by supershops. Their value proposition—rooted in freshness, relationship-based service, and hyper-convenience—aligns perfectly with the current needs of the average Bangladeshi consumer in semi-urban areas.

For modern supershops to gain more market share, they cannot simply rely on offering air-conditioned environments. They must address the core consumer belief that "local is fresher" and find ways to integrate into the local community's daily workflow. Until then, the traditional *Mudir Dokan* and *Kacha Bazar* will likely continue to dominate the retail heart of Bangladesh.

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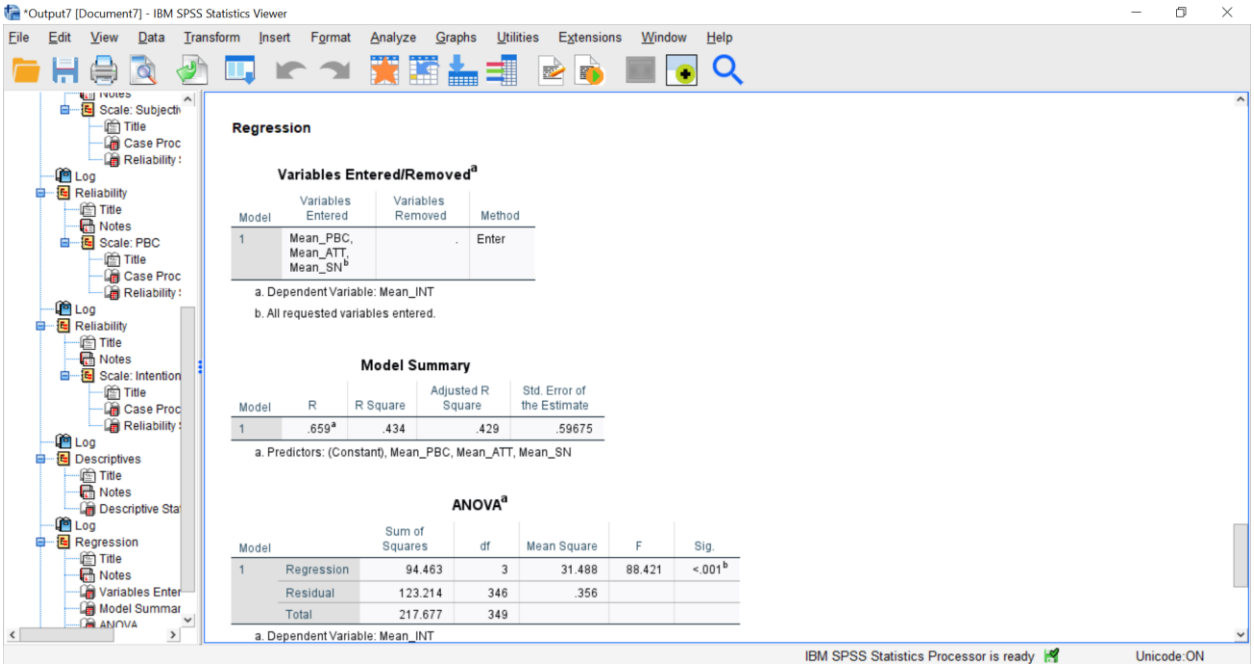
Appendix



*Output7 [Document7] - IBM SPSS Statistics Viewer

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Regression

Variables Entered/Removed[a]

Model	Variables Entered	Variables Removed	Method
1	Mean_PBC, Mean_ATT, Mean_SN[b]	.	Enter

a. Dependent Variable: Mean_INT

b. All requested variables entered.

Model Summary

Model	R	R Square	Adjusted R Square	Std. Error of the Estimate
1	.659[a]	.434	.429	.59675

a. Predictors: (Constant), Mean_PBC, Mean_ATT, Mean_SN

ANOVA[a]

Model		Sum of Squares	df	Mean Square	F	Sig.
1	Regression	94.463	3	31.488	88.421	<.001[b]
	Residual	123.214	346	.356		
	Total	217.677	349			

a. Dependent Variable: Mean_INT

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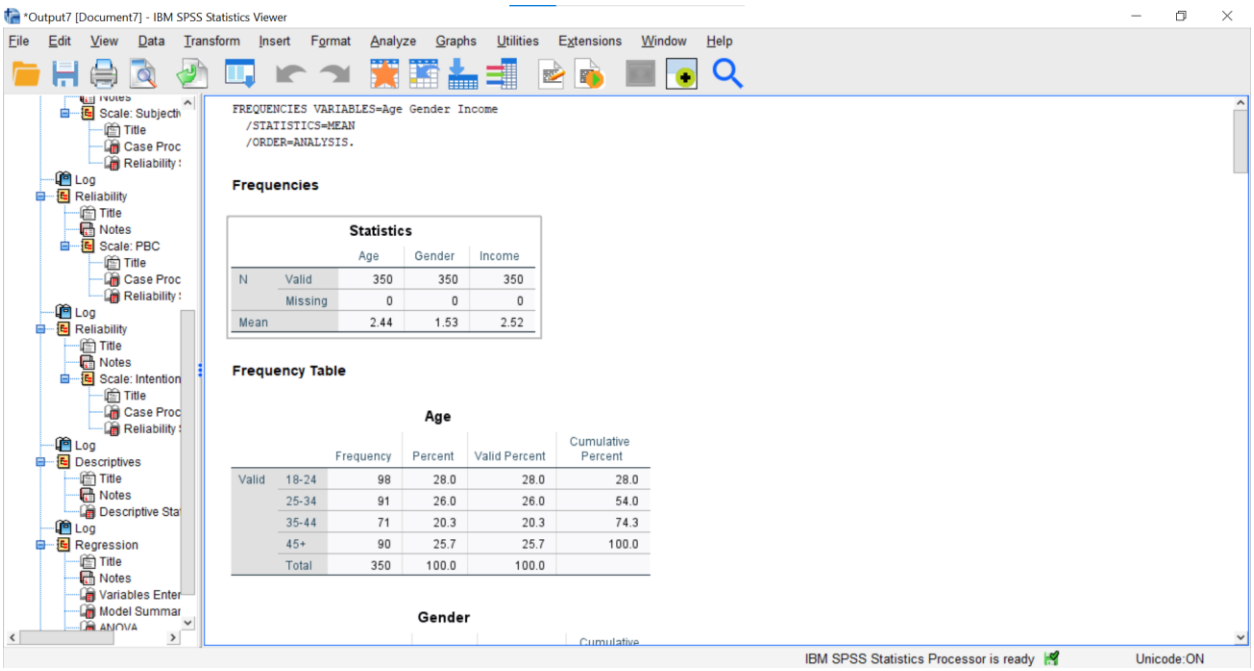

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```
FREQUENCIES VARIABLES=Age Gender Income
  /STATISTICS=MEAN
  /ORDER=ANALYSIS.
```

Frequencies

Statistics

		Age	Gender	Income
N	Valid	350	350	350
	Missing	0	0	0
Mean		2.44	1.53	2.52

Frequency Table

Age

		Frequency	Percent	Valid Percent	Cumulative Percent
Valid	18-24	98	28.0	28.0	28.0
	25-34	91	26.0	26.0	54.0
	35-44	71	20.3	20.3	74.3
	45+	90	25.7	25.7	100.0
	Total	350	100.0	100.0	

Gender

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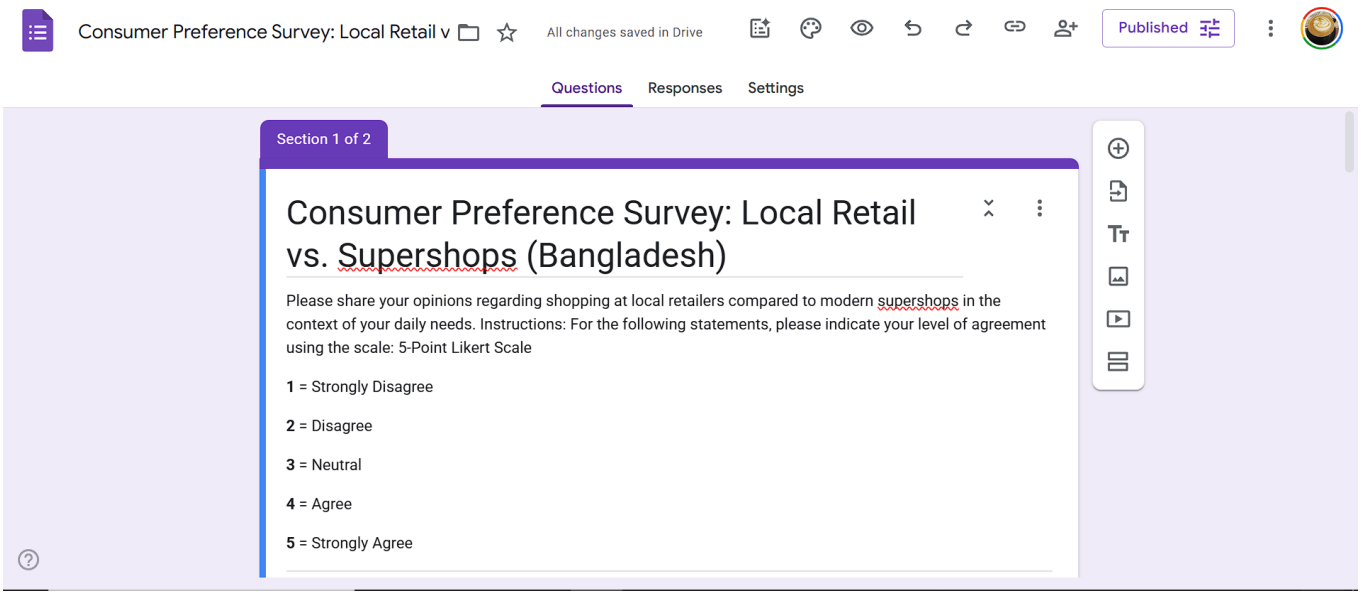

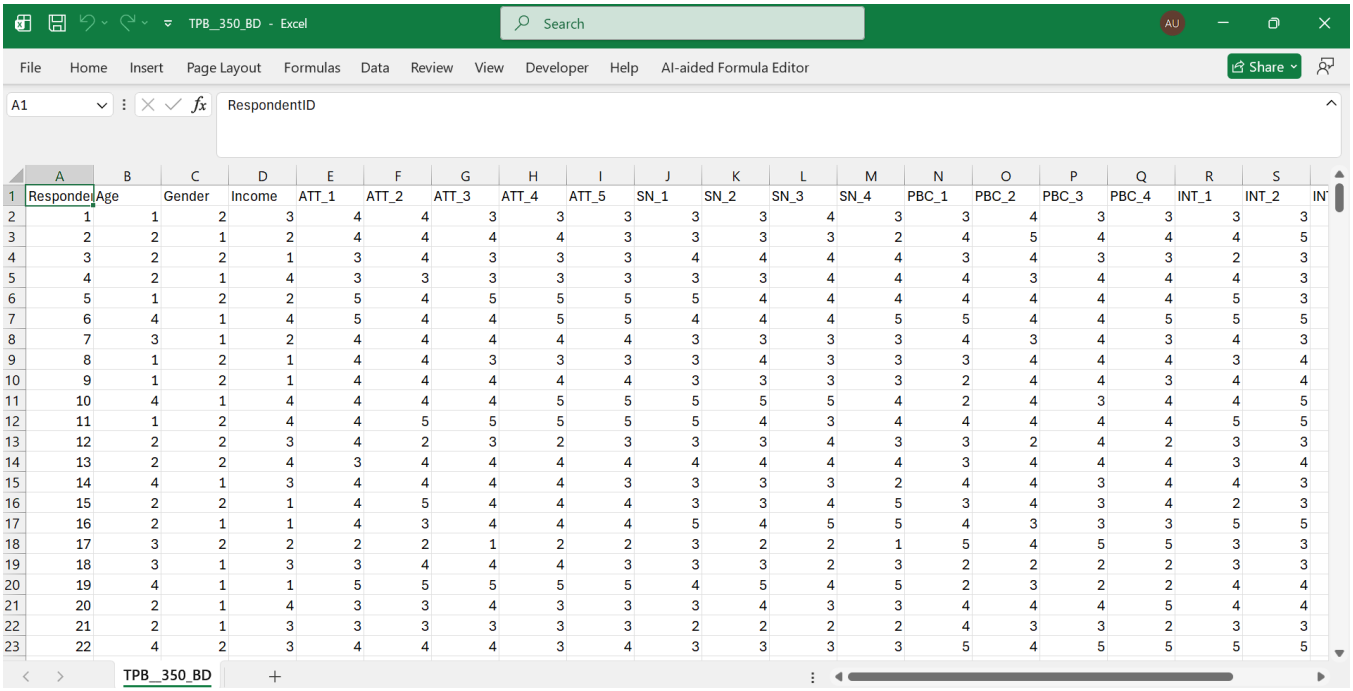

	A	B	C	D	E	F	G	H	I	J	K	L	M	N	O	P	Q	R	S
1	Respondent	Age	Gender	Income	ATT_1	ATT_2	ATT_3	ATT_4	ATT_5	SN_1	SN_2	SN_3	SN_4	PBC_1	PBC_2	PBC_3	PBC_4	INT_1	INT_2
2	1	1	2	3	4	4	3	3	3	3	3	4	3	3	4	3	3	3	3
3	2	2	1	2	4	4	4	4	3	3	3	3	2	4	5	4	4	4	5
4	3	2	2	1	3	4	3	3	3	4	4	4	4	3	4	3	3	2	3
5	4	2	1	4	3	3	3	3	3	3	3	4	4	4	3	4	4	4	3
6	5	1	2	2	5	4	5	5	5	5	4	4	4	4	4	4	4	5	3
7	6	4	1	4	5	4	4	5	5	4	4	4	5	5	4	4	5	5	5
8	7	3	1	2	4	4	4	4	4	3	3	3	3	4	3	4	3	4	3
9	8	1	2	1	4	4	3	3	3	3	4	3	3	3	4	4	4	3	4
10	9	1	2	1	4	4	4	4	4	3	3	3	3	2	4	4	3	4	4
11	10	4	1	4	4	4	4	5	5	5	5	5	4	2	4	3	4	4	5
12	11	1	2	4	4	5	5	5	5	5	4	3	4	4	4	4	4	5	5
13	12	2	2	3	4	2	3	2	3	3	3	4	3	3	2	4	2	3	3
14	13	2	2	4	3	4	4	4	4	4	4	4	4	3	4	4	4	3	4
15	14	4	1	3	4	4	4	4	3	3	3	3	2	4	4	3	4	4	3
16	15	2	2	1	4	5	4	4	4	3	3	4	5	3	4	3	4	2	3
17	16	2	1	1	4	3	4	4	4	5	4	5	5	4	3	3	3	5	5
18	17	3	2	2	2	2	1	2	2	3	2	2	1	5	4	5	5	3	3
19	18	3	1	3	3	4	4	4	3	3	3	2	3	2	2	2	2	3	3
20	19	4	1	1	5	5	5	5	5	4	5	4	5	2	3	2	2	4	4
21	20	2	1	4	3	3	4	3	3	3	4	3	3	4	4	4	5	4	4
22	21	2	1	3	3	3	3	3	3	2	2	2	2	4	3	3	2	3	3
23	22	4	2	3	4	4	4	3	4	3	3	3	3	5	4	5	5	5	5